

Emma Sedlak

>Civic & Investigative Reporter

Cleveland, OH

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Summary

Cleveland reporter who makes public systems legible: how benefits change, who qualifies for a tax break, what happens when an officer breaks the rules. Reports from public data – police discipline files, property deeds, court filings – and the neighborhoods those records describe.

Professional Experience

September 2025 – Present | Civic Reporter

Signal Cleveland

- > Covering local news in the city, translating complicated policy topics into clean, conversational writing
- > Designing custom interactive features and data visualizations for complex data stories using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript
- > Showed how housing investors avoid code enforcement and price out first time homebuyers by tracing a single investor's holdings across nine LLCs using county property, deed, municipal court, and Secretary of State records

May 2022 – Present | Documenter
Signal Cleveland

- > Attending Cleveland-area public meetings and produce detailed notes on discussions, votes, and public comments
- > Documenting key decisions and policy debates in real time to provide reliable source material that supports newsroom reporting and community transparency

Recent Projects

Cleveland Police Discipline Database
Signal Cleveland

- > Uncovering systemic patterns in police accountability by transforming 1,800+ fragmented disciplinary records into a searchable public database using Airtable and custom data visualizations

Community Listening Fellowship
Signal Cleveland

- > Interviewed 75 Cleveland residents about their concerns for the 2025 local elections
- > Summarized community feedback into a clear, people-centered agenda shared with candidates, media partners, and voters

Education

2021 – 2025 | BA in Political Studies
Pitzer College, Claremont, CA

GPA: 3.80

- > Honors thesis - "Why Democrats Lost Ohio," an analysis of county-level voter turnout data
- > Philosophy Minor

Skills

- > Data (Python, spreadsheets, Airtable)
- > Records (Ohio Sunshine Laws, FOIA)
- > Web (HTML/CSS/JS, WordPress)
- > Audience-Focused Writing & SEO
- > Copyediting & Proofreading
- > Adobe Suite